

EPISODE 3

JESUS CHRIST, DIVINE BRIDEGROOM

Description

In this episode, Dr. Bergsma discusses John 3–5, focusing on the image of Our Lord as Divine Bridegroom of Israel. He begins by examining the figures of Nicodemus and John the Baptist, who both appear in John 3. Through Our Lord’s conversation with Nicodemus, it becomes clear that, out of love for us, Jesus came to free us from sin and darkness. This is a powerful truth intimately connected with our baptism. Dr. Bergsma walks through Jesus’ encounter with the Samaritan woman, who, despite appearances, longs for the coming Messiah. Finally, Dr. Bergsma concludes this episode by discussing two of the “signs” performed by Our Lord: the healing of the official’s son, and the healing of the paralytic.

Outline

- ✿ Nicodemus asks Jesus about being “born again”, foreshadowing baptism
- ✿ John the Baptist identifies Jesus as the Bridegroom
- ✿ Jesus meets the Samaritan woman at Jacob’s well. He reveals Himself as the Messiah & Bridegroom of Israel
- ✿ Healing the official’s son: Anointing of the Sick
- ✿ Healing the paralytic: Sacrament of Reconciliation

My Notes

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

.....

Review Questions

1. In John 3:1-2, Nicodemus comes to Jesus by night. What does this action symbolize?
 - a. A lack of knowledge
 - b. The light of the Holy Spirit
 - c. Spiritual darkness
 - d. Both A & C
2. True or False: The Samaritan woman's adultery is symbolic of the idolatrous history of the Northern tribes.
 - a. True
 - b. False

Reflection Questions

1. Every year on the Third Sunday in Lent, the Church invites the faithful to reflect on the story of the woman at the well. In light of what Dr. Bergsma shared in this episode, why do you think the Church returns to this passage year after year? What aspects of the Samaritan woman's story reflect the themes of the Lenten season?
 2. What are your thoughts on the connection between the "living water" Jesus offers the Samaritan woman and the description of Solomon's bride as a "well of living water" in Song of Songs 4:15?
 3. Dr. Bergsma described the man Jesus healed in John 5 as an "icon of the people of Israel." When you examine this passage, what dimensions of the paralyzed man's story reflect the history of the Israelites in the Old Testament? What aspects of the man's encounter with Our Lord can offer insight into the Christian life today?
-
-

Practical Application

This week, try doing lectio divina prayer with the story of the Samaritan woman (John 4:1–41). Ask the Holy Spirit to help you listen to God's voice. Read slowly through the passage as many times as you need. When you encounter a word or phrase that stands out to you, pause and meditate on it. Enter into loving conversation with the Lord. Talk to Him openly and honestly about what you notice coming up in your heart as you reflect on this story.

Next Episode

Dr. Bergsma examines the famous Bread of Life Discourse. He shares how themes of light and water point toward Our Lord's self-gift on Calvary for the life of the world.